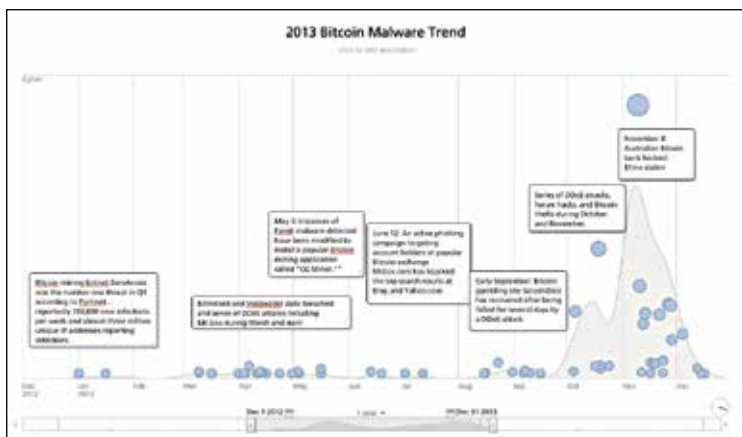


the top six countries suffering from Bitcoin malware according to research by Trend Micro. Basic precautions become more urgent in this context and the use of unknown softwares becomes a greater threat. Even the use of unknown USBs, DVDs and other devices can pose a risk as they are vector points where malware can enter our system.

In the event of suspected attack its critical that a complete system wipe we done at the hard disk level and a clean operating system be installed. In addition to which it makes more sense to pay and use as good an antivirus and firewall program as possible but to not blindly give in to their assur-



The latest research shows the extreme rise in Bitcoin based malware resulting in millions of losses.

ances. Personal vigilance is the first step to system and Bitcoin security. In this case, programs that are no longer used should be uninstalled since malware can harm the system using vulnerabilities in those softwares. Even visiting questionable websites should be looked at and it is advisable that it should be done through virtual machines (VirtualBox).

Bitcoin scam awareness

Where there is money, there is crime and Bitcoin is no different. Given the key features of Bitcoin like anonymity, irreversible transactions and active currency exchanges, criminals are very keen on parting coins from their owners without fear of being caught. Various types of scams and tricks have been used in this venture. The biggest losses in the brief history of